

Side Hustle Website Survival Kit

Stop losing sales to silent website problems.

Website Risk Scorecard

Use this once a week. Score 1 point for every YES.

Money page basics

1. My homepage loads on phone and desktop.
2. My main offer/product/service page loads.
3. My checkout, booking, order, or contact path works.
4. My contact form sends to the right email.
5. My business phone/email/social link is visible.
6. My SSL padlock is active and not expired.
7. My site loads in under 4 seconds on mobile data.
8. My most important button is visible without scrolling.
9. My refund/cancellation/contact expectations are clear.
10. My site has no obvious broken images or broken links.

Trust signals

11. Visitors can tell what I sell within 5 seconds.
12. Prices or next-step instructions are clear.
13. There is at least one trust signal: reviews, portfolio, guarantee, credentials, real photos, or clear business details.
14. The site does not look abandoned: current year, working links, updated hours, active inventory/services.
15. Customers know what happens after they pay, submit, or book.

Monitoring

16. I have a monitor watching the main website.
17. I have a monitor watching checkout/contact/booking.
18. I know who gets alerted if something breaks.
19. I have checked the site from my phone in the last 7 days.
20. I have a simple outage plan.

Score

- ? 17-20: Strong. Keep monitoring.
- ? 13-16: Good, but there are leaks to close.
- ? 8-12: Risky. You may be losing sales quietly.
- ? 0-7: Emergency mode. Fix the basics before sending traffic.

Money Page Monitoring Checklist

Monitor the pages that directly affect revenue, not just the homepage.

Monitor these first

- ? Homepage
- ? Product/service page
- ? Checkout page
- ? Booking page
- ? Contact page
- ? Lead form confirmation page
- ? Login/account page if customers need it
- ? API/status endpoint if your app depends on one

What to watch

- ? Page is reachable
- ? SSL certificate is valid
- ? Response time is not unusually slow
- ? Checkout/contact path still works
- ? Important images/scripts are not broken
- ? Domain renewal date is known
- ? Hosting bill/payment method is current

Suggested schedule

- ? Homepage: every 15-30 minutes
- ? Checkout/booking/contact: every 15 minutes
- ? SSL/domain review: monthly
- ? Full manual phone test: weekly

Warning signs

- ? Site loads sometimes, fails sometimes
- ? Mobile view is broken
- ? Contact form says "sent" but no email arrives
- ? Checkout works in test mode but not live mode
- ? SSL warning appears
- ? Plugin/theme update changed layout
- ? Speed suddenly gets worse

Simple rule

If a page can make or lose money, it deserves a monitor.

Outage Response Script

When your site breaks, do not panic-scroll. Follow this order.

1. Confirm the problem

? Open the site on your phone using cellular data.

? Open it in a private/incognito browser window.

? Test the exact customer path: view page ? click button ? submit/buy/book.

2. Identify the type of failure

? Whole site down

? One page down

? Checkout/payment broken

? Contact/lead form broken

? Site works but is very slow

? SSL/security warning

? Wrong content/pricing/hours shown

3. Immediate customer-safe action

Use the fastest temporary fix:

? Add a banner: ?We're fixing checkout. Email us at ____ for orders.?

? Update social bio/link if the main link is broken.

? Switch checkout/contact link to a backup form/payment link.

? Pause ads if paid traffic is being sent to a broken page.

4. Message template

?Quick heads up: our [checkout/contact/booking page] is having a temporary issue. We're fixing it now. If you need help right away, use [backup email/link]. Thanks for your patience.?

5. After it is fixed

? Test from phone and desktop.

? Save what broke and how it was fixed.

? Add a monitor so the same issue is caught faster next time.

15-Minute Weekly Site Health Routine

Do this once a week before sending traffic, posting offers, or running ads.

Minute 0-3: mobile check

- ? Open homepage on phone.
- ? Open main product/service page.
- ? Tap the main call-to-action.

Minute 3-6: money path check

- ? Start checkout, booking, or contact flow.
- ? Confirm button text and price are correct.
- ? Confirm confirmation page/message appears.

Minute 6-9: trust check

- ? Are hours, prices, links, and contact info current?
- ? Do reviews/testimonials/portfolio items still show?
- ? Is there anything that looks abandoned?

Minute 9-12: speed and broken stuff

- ? Scroll the page.
- ? Look for broken images, weird layout, slow loading, popups covering buttons.

Minute 12-15: log it

Record:

- ? Date checked
- ? What worked
- ? What broke
- ? Fix needed
- ? Next check date

Customer Trust Quick Fixes

These are small fixes that often matter more than fancy design.

Make it obvious

- ? What do you sell?
- ? Who is it for?
- ? What does it cost?
- ? What should the visitor do next?

Add trust

- ? Real business name
- ? Contact email
- ? Clear refund/cancellation policy
- ? Reviews, screenshots, case studies, portfolio, before/after examples
- ? Delivery timeline or service expectations

Remove doubt

- ? Replace vague buttons like ?Submit? with ?Get quote? or ?Book appointment.?
- ? Explain what happens after form submission.
- ? Put the main CTA near the top.
- ? Make phone/email tappable on mobile.
- ? Remove dead social links.

The 5-second test

Show your page to someone for 5 seconds. Ask:

1. What is this business selling?
2. Who is it for?
3. What should I click next?

If they cannot answer, the page is leaking money.

Launch Day Checklist

Use before launching a product, ad, website, sale, service, event, or campaign.

Before posting the link

- ? Homepage loads
- ? Offer page loads
- ? Checkout/booking/contact works
- ? Confirmation email/message arrives

- ? Price is correct
- ? Coupon code works, if used
- ? Mobile layout is usable
- ? Main image/video loads
- ? Terms/refund/contact info are visible
- ? Analytics/pixel installed, if used
- ? Backup contact method ready
- ? Monitor active on main page and money page

After posting

- ? Click your own link from the live post/email/profile.
- ? Test on phone using cellular data.
- ? Check for first visitor/order/form submission.
- ? Watch error messages for the first hour.

If something breaks

Pause traffic, switch to backup link, post a short fix message, and log the cause.

Tool Stack Under \$50

A low-budget stack for keeping a small money site alive.

Free / low-cost basics

- ? Domain registrar account with auto-renew enabled
- ? Hosting account with payment method current
- ? Free SSL certificate from host/Let's Encrypt
- ? Google Search Console
- ? Google Analytics or privacy-friendly analytics
- ? Uptime monitor such as PulsePage or another simple monitor
- ? A backup contact form/link
- ? A spreadsheet for weekly checks

Optional paid spend

- ? \$9-\$19: domain privacy/renewal buffer if needed
- ? \$0-\$20: simple logo/banner if needed
- ? \$0-\$10: Gumroad/Etsy listing images made with free tools
- ? \$0-\$50: only spend on traffic after checkout/contact is verified

Don't spend first on

- ? Fancy logo packages
- ? Generic ?business courses?
- ? Paid ads before the site path works
- ? Expensive tools before you have sales